Answer key: Lesson 1, What Time Is It?

For the tutor and grown-ups. Keep this page away from the child until they have finished and checked their own work. Ask *how do you know?* before saying right or wrong.

Start here (pages 1 and 2)

S1. Write the time for each clock.

Answer: 1:00; 8:00; 3:30; 9:30

The first two clocks have the long hand on the 12, so they are o'clock times: the short hand points to the 1 and the 8, so 1:00 and 8:00. The last two have the long hand on the 6, so they are half past: the short hand is half way between the 3 and the 4 (3:30) and half way between the 9 and the 10 (9:30).

Watch for: Writing 12:00 for the first two clocks (reading the long hand as the hour).; Writing 4:30 for the fourth clock (reading the number the short hand is going towards).

S2. Draw the hands to show 4 o'clock. Use a ruler. The short hand is shorter.

Answer: The short hand on the 4 and the long hand on the 12

For 4 o'clock the long hand points straight up to the 12, and the short hand points to the 4. The long hand is longer than the short hand.

Watch for: Drawing both hands the same length.; Drawing the long hand to the 4 and the short hand to the 12 (hands swapped).

S3. The bus leaves at half past 7. Circle the correct clock.

Answer: Clock (2)

Half past 7 is 7:30. The long hand is on the 6 and the short hand is half way between the 7 and the 8. That is clock (2). Clock (1) is 7 o'clock and clock (3) is half past 1.

Watch for: Choosing clock (1): 7 o'clock, not half past 7.; Choosing clock (3): the long hand is right but the short hand is near the 1.

S4. Look at the clock. Choose the correct answer. Write its number in the bracket.

Answer: (1) 2 o'clock

The long hand is on the 12, so it is an o'clock time. The short hand points to the 2. The time is 2 o'clock, 2:00.

Watch for: Choosing (3) 12 o'clock: reading the long hand as the hour.; Choosing (2): half past needs the long hand on the 6.

S5. Ben, Mei and Ali wake up at different times. Look at the clocks.

Answer: Mei; Ben

Ben wakes up at 7:00, Mei at 5:00 and Ali at 5:30. The earliest time is 5:00, so Mei wakes up first. The latest time is 7:00, so Ben wakes up last.

Watch for: Choosing Ali for first because 5:30 has a bigger number than 5:00.; Comparing only the long hands.

S6. Fill in the blanks. Write short or long.

Answer: short; long

The short hand names the hour. The long hand counts the minutes, 5 minutes for each number.

Watch for: Swapping the two words.; Writing hour and minutes instead of short and long.

Think harder (page 3)

T1. Write the time for each clock.

Answer: 7:15; 2:45

First clock: the long hand is on the 3. Count 5, 10, 15, so it is 15 minutes past 7: 7:15. Second clock: the long hand is on the 9. Count 5, 10, 15, 20, 25, 30, 35, 40, 45, so it is 45 minutes past 2: 2:45.

Watch for: Writing 7:3 and 2:9 (writing the number the long hand points to).; Writing 3:45 for the second clock (reading the number the short hand is near).

T2. A child says this clock shows 9:30.

Answer: No; 8:30

The long hand is on the 6, so it is half past. The short hand is half way between the 8 and the 9. It has passed the 8 but not reached the 9, so the time is 8:30.

Watch for: Saying Yes because the short hand is near the 9.; Writing 9:30 or 8:06.

T3. Look at the clock. Decide if each statement is True or False.

Answer: False; True; True

The long hand is on the 3, so it is 15 minutes past. The short hand is just past the 4, so it has passed the 4. The time is 4:15, quarter past 4. So: False (it is not 3:20); True; True.

Watch for: Saying the time is 3:20 because the long hand is on the 3.; Saying the short hand has not passed the 4 because it looks close to the 4.

Go further (page 4)

G1. Lily sees a wall clock in the bathroom mirror. In the mirror it shows 4 o'clock. A mirror swaps left and right. What is the real time?

Answer: 8

In the mirror the short hand points to the 4, on the right of the 12. A mirror swaps left and right, so really the short hand is on the left, the same number of steps from the 12. That is the 8. The real time is 8 o'clock.

Watch for: Writing 4 (the time in the mirror).; Writing 6 or 12 (counting the steps the wrong way).

G2. Later, the mirror shows half past 7. What is the real time?

Answer: 4

In the mirror the long hand is on the 6, so it is half past. The short hand is half way between the 7 and the 8. Swap left and right: it is half way between the 4 and the 5. The real time is half past 4, 4:30.

Watch for: Writing 7 (the mirror time).; Writing 5 (the number the short hand is going towards).

G3. Lily says: at 12 o'clock the clock in the mirror shows 12 o'clock too.

Answer: Yes; 6

At 12 o'clock both hands point straight up. A mirror swaps left and right, but straight up stays straight up. So Lily is right. At 6 o'clock the short hand points straight down, and the long hand points straight up, so a mirror does not change the clock. The other time is 6 o'clock.

Watch for: Saying No because the hands are on top of each other.; Writing 3 or 9 (a mirror swaps these two).

Investigation (page 5): Where is the short hand?

Between the 4 and the 5, half way. In one whole hour the short hand moves from the 4 to the 5. Half past 4 is half an hour after 4 o'clock, so the short hand has moved half of the way.

Look for: A child who says between, and gives a reason such as it moves a bit when the long hand moves, or half an hour is half of the way. Credit any clear reason. Do not mark a child down for stopping at between.

Exit ticket (page 5)

E1. Write the time for each clock.

Answer: 6:00; 6:30

The first clock has the long hand on the 12, so it is an o'clock time, and the short hand points to the 6: 6:00. The second clock has the long hand on the 6, so it is half past, and the short hand is half way between the 6 and the 7: 6:30.

Watch for: Writing 12:00 for the first clock (reading the long hand as the hour).; Writing 7:30 for the second clock (the number the short hand is going towards).

E2. Draw the hands to show half past 5. Use a ruler. The short hand is shorter.

Answer: Long hand on the 6; short hand half way between the 5 and the 6

Half past means the long hand points to the 6. The short hand is half way between the 5 and the 6.

Watch for: Drawing the short hand exactly on the 5 or the 6.; Drawing the long hand to the 5.

E3. The long hand is on the 6. Circle o'clock or half past.

Answer: half past

When the long hand is on the 6, half an hour has gone. It is half past. The long hand is on the 12 for an o'clock time.

Watch for: Circling o'clock because 6 sounds like an hour.

Sneak-peek puzzles (not in the workbook)

1. 9:00 (9 o'clock)
2. 2:30 (half past 2)